

Feature

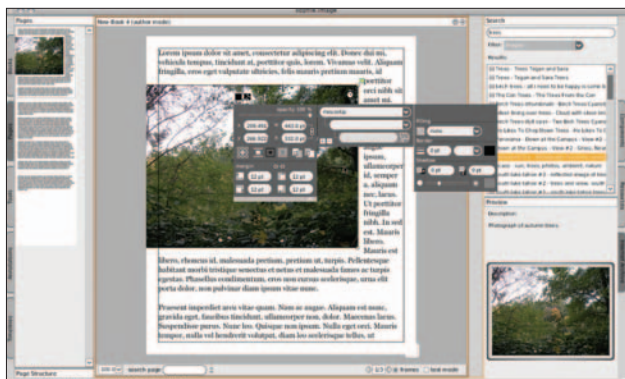
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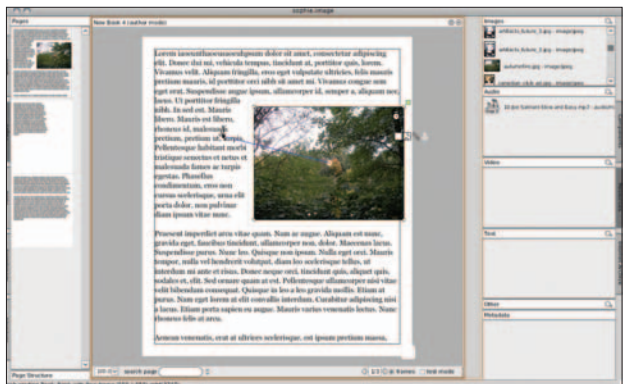
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You'll have a bunch of HUDs to fiddle with for images, too

One neat feature you have at your disposal here is the Anchor halo, which lets you attach your image to a text frame, paragraph, line or even character. To illustrate, let's say that the image you just added to your book needs to be associated with the third paragraph. You've taken the time to position it well, and you're happy with the way the text and image complement each other. But now, you must add text before the paragraph, which means that you must now reposition the image once again. With Sophie, however, you can position the image the way you want it, and then anchor it to the paragraph. Here's how: once you've positioned the image, click and drag the Anchor halo to the paragraph to which you want to attach it. Now, click on the halo (don't drag), and in the HUD, choose Paragraph. Now every time this paragraph moves, the picture will move with it.

Anchoring is especially handy when you need to attach small



Caption: Anchoring an image to a paragraph is a two-click job

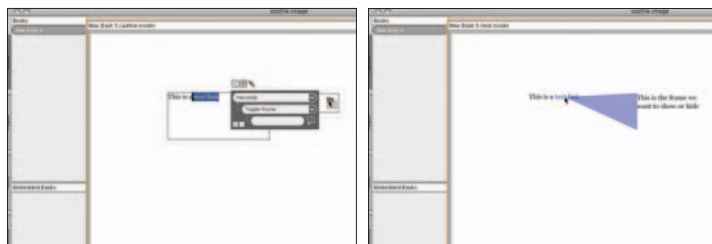
images to words – for example, the image of a toolbar button next to its name.

Getting Interactive

You can't get far with any rich media authoring tool if you don't have some interactive goodness thrown in, and Sophie lets you do plenty on that front. To make anything interactive, select it and click on the Links halo (the one that looks like a chain). First, you need to choose an event that will trigger the action you want – the mouseUp event, for example, means that your action will start when you click and then release the mouse button over the link. Once you've chosen your event, you've got several options ahead of you – you can make the link open a URL, turn to a page of the book, and, our favourite, turn a text frame off and on. Here's how you do it: first, choose mouseUp as your event. In the menu below, choose Toggle Frame. Finally,

drag the flag next to the last text box, and drop it over the frame you want toggled every time you click on the link. If you want a transparent "beam" to point from the link to the frame, check Show Annobeam.

You can also add more actions to the link by clicking on the "+" at the bottom-left of the HUD. To preview the results of your tinkering, select Test Mode at the bottom right of your book. To get back to editing, un-check Test Mode.



Toggling images can be fun

Share!

Finally, when you've had your fun with the program and finished your book, you can send it to your friends (or group members) for them to comment on. There are two ways for you to let people comment on your work: the first is to ask them to comment on specific areas. To do this, switch to the Components tab on the right, and from under Text Frames, drag a Comment into your text. Adjust the size of the comment frame, and you're ready to publish your book: choose File > Publish Book to create a .sophie file that your team can read and comment on. Once you've published your book, readers will be able to add comments by clicking on the addComment links. They'll also be able to reply to previous comments and start conversations.



You can start conversations with a comment text frame

The bad news with comment frames, however, is that they may bump your text around, which isn't desirable at all. Which is why you have stickies. Under the Annotations tab on the left, you'll find options to create sticky notes, highlights, and even audio annotations.

Right now, anyone you collaborate with will need their own copy of Sophie or Sophie Reader installed, but the next version of Sophie promises to bring these features to an online version of the Sophie Reader.

Footnote

Sophie's interface has a frustrating lack of any right-click menus or keyboard shortcuts, so it's likely you'll be frustrated with it for a while. Once you get used to it, however, its benefits far outweigh its shortcomings, and it's one of the best tools we've seen this side of Acrobat. ■

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